

Data Collection SOP (Patrols, Surveys, Sensors)

- Use approved tools: SMART/CyberTracker (patrols), Kobo Collect (surveys), calibrated camera traps, audio recorders
- Assign UICs for any social data; never record direct personal identifiers in analytical datasets
- Ensure device clock/GPS are synchronized before deployment
- Standardize metadata: device ID, start/end timestamps, operator ID, site code
- Follow sample chain-of-custody for eDNA and biological samples
- Use offline-capable forms; sync at secure upload points to central staging
- Record any deviations or incidents in field notes and attach to dataset during ingestion